

First-Let Landlord Pack (England)

Checklist and inventory for letting a property, 2026 edition

Reflects the Renters' Rights Act changes in force from 1 May 2026. A record-keeping aid, not legal advice; rules differ in Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland. Checked against gov.uk on 25 September 2026. Written with AI assistance and checked by a person.

1. Before you advertise

- ☐ Mortgage lender has consented to letting (or you have a buy-to-let mortgage)
- ☐ Landlord insurance in place (buildings, and contents if furnished)
- ☐ Council licensing checked: mandatory HMO, additional or selective licence where you are
- ☐ Energy Performance Certificate valid and rated E or above (or a registered exemption)
- ☐ Gas Safety Record from a Gas Safe engineer (within the last 12 months)
- ☐ Electrical Installation Condition Report (EICR) within the last 5 years, with remedial work done
- ☐ Smoke alarm on every storey; CO alarm in every room with a fixed combustion appliance (not gas cookers)
- ☐ Legionella risk assessed; furniture meets fire-safety labelling if furnished
- ☐ Advert states a rent, and you will not invite or accept offers above it (no rental bidding)
- ☐ You will not refuse tenants because they have children or receive benefits

2. Choosing a tenant

- ☐ Right to Rent checks done for all adults before the tenancy starts (keep copies)
- ☐ Holding deposit no more than 1 week's rent (Tenant Fees Act 2019)
- ☐ No banned fees charged (only rent, capped deposits and permitted payments)
- ☐ You will not ask for rent in advance beyond what the Renters' Rights Act allows (check gov.uk before taking any)

3. Before move-in day

- ☐ Written statement of tenancy terms given before the tenancy starts (assured periodic tenancy)
- ☐ Tenancy deposit no more than 5 weeks' rent (annual rent under £50,000)
- ☐ Deposit protected in a government-approved scheme within 30 days, and prescribed information given
- ☐ Copies given to the tenant: Gas Safety Record, EPC, EICR, and any other documents gov.uk currently requires
- ☐ Inventory completed with dated photos (see next pages) and signed by both of you
- ☐ Meter readings taken; council tax and utility providers told

4. Move-in day

- ☐ Smoke and CO alarms tested and working at the start of the tenancy
- ☐ Keys handed over and recorded
- ☐ Tenant shown the stopcock, fuse box, boiler controls and alarm test buttons

5. After the tenancy starts

- ☐ Diary: gas safety every 12 months, EICR every 5 years, EPC expiry, licence expiry, insurance renewal
- ☐ Rent increases: at most once a year using a section 13 notice
- ☐ Pet requests: consider each one, reply in writing, and do not refuse unreasonably
- ☐ Repairs logged and dealt with promptly; keep records
- ☐ HMRC: register for Self Assessment if needed; check whether Making Tax Digital applies (income over £50,000 now, £30,000 from April 2027)
- ☐ Watch gov.uk for the private rented sector database and landlord ombudsman start dates

Inventory and check-in report

Property address			
Tenant(s)		Check-in date	

Meters and keys

Item	Reading / number	Photo ref
Electricity meter		
Gas meter		
Water meter		
Front door keys		
Back door keys		
Window keys		
Fobs / cards		

Room by room

Hallway

Item	Condition	Cleanliness	Photo ref
Walls and ceiling			
Floor / carpet			
Windows, curtains, blinds			

Doors and handles			
Lights and sockets			
Furniture / appliances			

Living room

Item	Condition	Cleanliness	Photo ref
Walls and ceiling			
Floor / carpet			
Windows, curtains, blinds			
Doors and handles			
Lights and sockets			
Furniture / appliances			

Kitchen

Item	Condition	Cleanliness	Photo ref
Walls and ceiling			
Floor / carpet			
Windows, curtains, blinds			
Doors and handles			
Lights and sockets			
Furniture / appliances			

Bedroom 1

Item	Condition	Cleanliness	Photo ref
Walls and ceiling			
Floor / carpet			
Windows, curtains, blinds			
Doors and handles			
Lights and sockets			
Furniture / appliances			

Bedroom 2

Item	Condition	Cleanliness	Photo ref
Walls and ceiling			
Floor / carpet			
Windows, curtains, blinds			
Doors and handles			
Lights and sockets			
Furniture / appliances			

Bathroom

Item	Condition	Cleanliness	Photo ref
Walls and ceiling			
Floor / carpet			

Windows, curtains, blinds			
Doors and handles			
Lights and sockets			
Furniture / appliances			

Signatures

Landlord / agent		Date	
Tenant		Date	

Both parties keep a signed copy. Add dated photos; they are the best evidence in a deposit dispute.